

**SYNTHETIC TRAINING RECORD — FICTIONAL PARTIES, PEOPLE,
AGENCIES, SYSTEMS, IDENTIFIERS, AND EVENTS — NOT A REAL
FILING OR CYBERSECURITY GUIDE**

FOIA Request for Grid Sentinel Cyber-Response Playbooks

Date: June 3, 2024 **From:** Nila Quen, Executive Director, Open Grid Archive **To:** Freedom of Information Officer, fictional DOE Office of Resilience Exercise Records **Subject:** Final and superseded Grid Sentinel playbooks

Open Grid Archive requests agency records under 5 U.S.C. § 552. Open Grid is a fictional Maryland nonprofit that publishes explanatory material about public administration. The request concerns the fictional Grid Sentinel playbook suite and does not seek access to any live network, incident, facility, credential, or government employee's private information.

Please search for final or superseded editions of the Operational Decision Tree, Cyber-Incident Escalation Matrix, and Response-Coordination Appendix that were in effect at any time from January 1, 2022, through May 31, 2024. The request also includes final memoranda approving those editions and logs identifying when one edition replaced another. Open Grid seeks the records as maintained, including reasonably segregable administrative text.

For correspondence, use the fictional contact Nila Quen at Open Grid Archive, Meridian Borough, Maryland. Electronic delivery is preferred. This letter bears Open Grid's internal subject description only; the agency may assign its own tracking number when the request is received.

Requested Record Families

The first requested family is each final Operational Decision Tree used within Grid Sentinel during the stated period. This means the approved document that organizes response decisions, not software, executable logic, source code, event logs, or instructions for reaching a system. A table of contents, revision block, approval page, and nonoperational headings remain within scope even if particular operational passages are withheld.

The second family is each final Cyber-Incident Escalation Matrix. Open Grid seeks the approved matrix and its descriptive legend. The request excludes personal telephone numbers, personal email addresses, credentials, building-access information, and incident-specific entries. It also excludes any attachment that describes an actual threat, victim, or active investigation.

The third family is each final Response-Coordination Appendix. Requested material includes role descriptions, revision history, distribution statements, and general coordination language. It does not include live contact rosters or technical diagrams.

The fourth family consists of final governance records: approval memoranda, supersession notices, and distribution logs showing a playbook's title, version, effective date, and responsible fictional office. Drafts, comments, and deliberative email are not requested. Open Grid asks the agency to treat these four families separately when determining responsiveness and segregability.

Time, Version, and Custodian Limits

The temporal boundary is based on a document's effective period, not merely its creation date. A record qualifies if a final version governed at any point between January 1, 2022, and May 31, 2024. A final version replaced during that interval remains responsive. A draft never approved for use does not. Open Grid anticipates that the relevant files will be held by the fictional Office of Resilience Exercise Records and by personnel responsible for controlled playbook publication.

The search may be limited to records whose title, metadata, or approved indexing terms contain "Grid Sentinel," "Operational Decision Tree," "Cyber-Incident Escalation Matrix," "Response-Coordination Appendix," "revision approval," or "supersession." A reference in unrelated correspondence does not make the correspondence responsive unless the message itself is the final approval or supersession record.

To avoid collecting sensitive operational data, Open Grid affirmatively excludes event telemetry, investigative case files, raw alerts, system configurations, vendor materials, vulnerability reports, credentials, source code, access-control lists, and maps of real infrastructure. It also excludes individual incident after-action reports. Those exclusions are intended to reduce search burden, not to concede that every excluded category would be exempt from disclosure.

Format, Fees, and Public Benefit

Please provide responsive records electronically in searchable PDF form when reasonably available. Native files are not requested. If a responsive record exists only as a scanned image, a readable scan is sufficient. Open Grid asks that each produced record retain its title page, revision block, and other nonexempt context so a reader can understand what was reviewed and what portion was withheld.

Open Grid seeks classification as a representative of the news media for fee purposes because it gathers information of potential public interest, applies editorial judgment, and distributes explanatory publications. It does not seek the records for a commercial use. Open Grid also requests a public-interest fee waiver. Disclosure would help explain how an agency describes the governance of preparedness materials, including how final versions are approved and superseded. The requested administrative information is not already available to Open Grid.

If anticipated fees will exceed \$75, please provide a written estimate before incurring additional costs. Open Grid authorizes up to that amount without further consultation. The organization is willing to discuss a staged production or a narrower set of final versions if the agency identifies a concrete source of unusual burden. Agreement to confer does not withdraw the request or waive any statutory timing position.

Exemptions, Foreseeable Harm, and Segregability

If the agency withholds information, Open Grid asks that the response identify the statutory basis and describe the withheld material sufficiently to permit an informed administrative appeal. For Exemption 7(E), please distinguish techniques or procedures from guidelines and explain any applicable disclosure harm without revealing the information asserted to be protected. For Exemption 7(F), please connect the withheld category to an expected danger to life or physical safety.

Open Grid recognizes that a response need not reproduce sensitive content in order to explain a determination. It nevertheless requests a record-specific accounting rather than a single rationale applied to every page. The accounting should distinguish a record withheld in full from a record released with redactions and should identify whether more than one exemption overlaps on the same material.

Please release every reasonably segregable nonexempt portion after deletion of exempt matter. Titles, dates, revision identifiers, approval history, general purpose statements, and administrative headings should be evaluated independently from any protected operational detail. The response should also address the foreseeable-harm requirement in 5 U.S.C. § 552(a)(8)(A). If a full record cannot be produced, a redacted copy is preferred to a categorical refusal whenever meaningful nonexempt text remains.

Preservation and Contact

Open Grid requests preservation of responsive final versions and their ordinary metadata while this request and any administrative review are pending. This is a records-preservation request only. It does not seek creation of new reports, restoration of inaccessible backup media, or interruption of ordinary system operations. The agency may identify a more suitable fictional component if the Office of Resilience Exercise Records is not the proper custodian.

Questions may be directed to Nila Quen. Tamsin Roe and Leo Marr are fictional counsel available to assist with scope discussions, but counsel need not be copied on routine production notices. Open Grid welcomes a written clarification request that identifies the ambiguous phrase and proposes a practical construction.

I certify that the descriptions in this request concern only the synthetic Grid Sentinel exercise materials defined above. No real system, facility, employee, or operational method is intended. Please acknowledge receipt, assign a tracking number, state the fee category, and identify any anticipated unusual circumstances. Electronic delivery of the acknowledgment and later determination will satisfy the requested method of correspondence.

Respectfully submitted,

Nila Quen Executive Director, Open Grid Archive Fictional requester